

The Year Of Broadband?

We'll see cheaper, faster connections this year. We'll also see new technologies like WiMAX coming to the fore—Bharti TeleVentures, Reliance, Sify, BSNL, and VSNL have all acquired licenses to provide it, and Sify showed off their first live demonstration on February 19.

At least, this is what we've been promised.

There will also be innovation in the way broadband is provided—for example, in keeping with his idea of the “Indian pricing model,” Ajwani envisions the advent of “Broadband On Demand”—the ability to ask only for the bandwidth you need, when you need it. But that's only half of it.

The way we use broadband is changing—even ISPs in the US weren't prepared for the volume of content that's now available online. Horror stories of Comcast cutting off users' connections for exceeding their bandwidth limits (on supposedly “unlimited” connections, mind you) have already begun to surface.

At the India Digital Summit 2007, Maran pointed out, “Connectivity, of course, is not enough to ensure adoption of Internet. Content is another significant contributor to it—I have to say we do not have much content today for consumers!”

Consider this: YouTube—an English-language site—is now number 7 on the list of sites most frequented by Indians. “Now imagine a Hindi YouTube in India,” says Chakravarthy.

Though Maran has made lofty promises, but Chakravarthy has complete faith in the min-

ister: “He's a performing minister, and he's serious when he says these things. He's almost running the Indian IT sector like a CEO.” As for the “Year of Broadband” and all that it promises, “He'll get it done.”

Disconnect

You probably expected us to crucify your provider for daring to interrupt your download. Or tell you that you'll see a 2 Mbps unlimited connection for Rs 250 a month, two weeks from now. Perhaps you even expected this writer to rail about the fact that while he writes this, a 200 KB file is downloading at 2 Kbps in the background. Or that the “Hah!” in broad(hah!)band will never go. Pity.

We just need to give it time. The datacentres will come, and prices will fall. PC prices will fall, penetration will increase, and then broadband prices will fall. In the mean time, you can do your bit to help broadband and PC penetration by making them more desirable—if you know someone who's worried about what their kids will get exposed to online, tell them about the whole world of knowledge waiting out there. The television faced the same kind of resistance, but with acceptance came adoption.

We know you've got a broadband anecdote to share—how could you not? Will you content yourself with value-added services while you wait for prices to fall? Will you opt for IPTV? Is the country doomed to sub-standard speeds? Write in—our inboxes are quite large! ■

nimish_chandiramani@thinkdigit.com



www.corsair.com

Cool Performance



CORSAIR



Dominator Airflow Fan

10 Years NO QUESTIONS ASKED 1-1 Swap Warranty



Power Supplies



Laptop Memory



PC/Server Memory



USB Drives



TIRUPATI ENTERPRISES
BRING YOU THE BEST OF DIGITAL WORLD
WWW.TIRUPATI.NET

Kolkata (H.O.) - 09339207519, Guwahati - 09135012132, New Delhi - 09350172803,
Mumbai - 09323170474, Pune - 09370223844, Ahmedabad - 09377391919, Hyderabad - 09391012215,
Jierkhand & Bilur - 09334255870, Trivandrum - 0471 2338200, Bangalore 080-41205474,
Chennai - 09840077334, Cochin 09388953537.